

Core Framework Reference Guide

Business Process Framework (eTOM)

Business Process Framework Primer

GB921 Addendum P

Maturity Level: General availability (GA)	Team Approved Date: 09-Dec-2022
Release Status: Production	Approval Status: TM Forum Approved Suitable for Conformance
Version 22.5.0	IPR Mode: RAND

Notice

Copyright © TM Forum 2023. All Rights Reserved.

This document and translations of it may be copied and furnished to others, and derivative works that comment on or otherwise explain it or assist in its implementation may be prepared, copied, published, and distributed, in whole or in part, without restriction of any kind, provided that the above copyright notice and this section are included on all such copies and derivative works. However, this document itself may not be modified in any way, including by removing the copyright notice or references to TM FORUM, except as needed for the purpose of developing any document or deliverable produced by a TM FORUM Collaboration Project Team (in which case the rules applicable to copyrights, as set forth in the [TM FORUM IPR Policy](#), must be followed) or as required to translate it into languages other than English.

The limited permissions granted above are perpetual and will not be revoked by TM FORUM or its successors or assigns.

This document and the information contained herein is provided on an "AS IS" basis and TM FORUM DISCLAIMS ALL WARRANTIES, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO ANY WARRANTY THAT THE USE OF THE INFORMATION HEREIN WILL NOT INFRINGE ANY OWNERSHIP RIGHTS OR ANY IMPLIED WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR A PARTICULAR PURPOSE.

TM FORUM invites any TM FORUM Member or any other party that believes it has patent claims that would necessarily be infringed by implementations of this TM Forum Standards Final Deliverable, to notify the TM FORUM Team Administrator and provide an indication of its willingness to grant patent licenses to such patent claims in a manner consistent with the IPR Mode of the TM FORUM Collaboration Project Team that produced this deliverable.

The TM FORUM invites any party to contact the TM FORUM Team Administrator if it is aware of a claim of ownership of any patent claims that would necessarily be infringed by implementations of this TM FORUM Standards Final Deliverable by a patent holder that is not willing to provide a license to such patent claims in a manner consistent with the IPR Mode of the TM FORUM Collaboration Project Team that produced this TM FORUM Standards Final Deliverable. TM FORUM may include such claims on its website but disclaims any obligation to do so.

TM FORUM takes no position regarding the validity or scope of any intellectual property or other rights that might be claimed to pertain to the implementation or use of the technology described in this TM FORUM Standards Final Deliverable or the extent to which any license under such rights might or might not be available; neither does it represent that it has made any effort to identify any such rights. Information on TM FORUM's procedures with respect to rights in any document or deliverable produced by a TM FORUM Collaboration Project Team can be found on the TM FORUM website. Copies of claims of rights made available for publication and any assurances of licenses to be made available, or the result of an attempt made to obtain a general license or permission for the use of such proprietary rights by implementers or users of this TM FORUM Standards Final Deliverable, can be obtained from the TM FORUM Team Administrator. TM FORUM makes no representation that any information or list of intellectual property rights will at any time be complete, or that any claims in such list are, in fact, Essential Claims.

Direct inquiries to the TM Forum office:

181 New Road, Suite 304
Parsippany, NJ 07054 USA
Tel No. +1 862 227 1648
TM Forum Web Page: www.TM Forum.org

Table of Contents

NOTICE	2
TABLE OF CONTENTS	4
LIST OF FIGURES.....	5
EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	6
1. WHAT IS THE BUSINESS PROCESS FRAMEWORK?	7
2. WHERE DID THE BUSINESS PROCESS FRAMEWORK COME FROM?	9
3. HOW DOES THE BUSINESS PROCESS FRAMEWORK WORK?.....	10
3.1 DOMAIN DEFINITION.....	10
3.2 PROCESS DECOMPOSITIONS	10
3.3 PROCESS FLOWS	17
4. WHY USE THE BUSINESS PROCESS FRAMEWORK?	22
5. WHEN CAN THE BUSINESS PROCESS FRAMEWORK HELP?	23
6. WHO IS USING THE BUSINESS PROCESS FRAMEWORK?	24
7. SOME IDEAS ON USING THE BUSINESS PROCESS FRAMEWORK.....	25
8. ADMINISTRATIVE APPENDIX.....	28
8.1 ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS	28
8.2 DOCUMENT HISTORY	28
8.2.1 Version History.....	28
8.2.2 Release History	29

List of Figures

Figure 1-1: Process Decomposition	11
Figure 1-2: Business Process Framework (eTOM)	12
Figure 1-3 : The Business Process Framework Operations (OPS) Processes	13
Figure 1-4 : Level 2 Operations (OPS) Processes	14
Figure 1-5 : An example of Level 3 Operations (OPS) Processes	15
Figure 1-6: The Business Process Framework Strategy to Readiness (S2R) Processes.....	15
Figure 1-7: Level 2 Strategy to Readiness (S2R) Processes	16
Figure 1-8: The Business Process Framework Enterprise Domain Processes.....	17
Figure 1-9: Process Flow (partial example only)	18
Figure 1-10: General Interaction Diagram for Production Order to Acceptance	19
Figure 1-11: Process Interaction Flow Diagram for Production Order to Acceptance	19
Figure 1-12: Process Interaction Flow Diagram for Trouble Ticket-to-Solution (Assurance)	20
Figure 1-13: Process Dynamics Flow Diagram for Trouble Ticket-to-Solution (Assurance)	21

Executive Summary

This document is an Addendum to the Business Process Framework, (GB921). It assists new readers and users of Business Process Framework by providing an introductory view of some of the concepts, goals, and structure of the Business Process Framework work.

It should be read in conjunction with the main GB921 document, and other Addenda (see GB921 Concepts and Principles for details).

1. What is the Business Process Framework?

The Communications and Digital services industry is facing unprecedented churn and the struggle to remain profitable in the face of more competition, higher customer expectations, falling market share and growing price pressures. The industry has a need to clearly define and understand the business processes involved in order to tackle these issues. It also needs to reach a consensus on the common process view for equipment suppliers, applications builders and integrators to build management systems by combining third party and in-house developments.

The Business Process Framework (also known as the eTOM) is an ongoing TM Forum initiative to deliver a business process model or framework for use by Communications and Digital services industry. The goal is to set a vision for the industry to enable it to compete successfully through the implementation of business process-driven approaches to managing the enterprise. This includes ensuring integration among all vital enterprise support systems concerned with service delivery and support.

The focus of the Business Process Framework is on the business processes used by service providers, the linkages between these processes, the identification of interfaces, and the use of customer, service, resource, supplier/partner and other information by multiple processes. The TM Forum Business Process Framework is a reference framework for categorizing all the business activities that a service provider will use, in a structured manner that allows these to be addressed at various levels of detail. For such companies, it serves as the blueprint for process direction and provides a neutral reference point for internal process reengineering needs, partnerships, alliances, and general working agreements with other providers. For suppliers, the Business Process Framework outlines potential boundaries of software components to align with the customers' needs and highlights the required functions, inputs, and outputs that must be supported by products.

A particular strength of the Business Process Framework is that as a foundation core element in the former Framework program, it provided a foundation along with other works underway in the Open Digital Framework (ODF) program, namely the evolution of the Information Framework, the Application Framework along with Open APIs, along with ODA and other TM Forum leading programs.

So, the Business Process Framework defines a business-oriented view of the enterprise. This view is useful for planners, managers, strategists, etc., who need to view the enterprise in business terms, without immediate concern for the nature of the way that these business needs are organized or automated within the business. Therefore, the Business Process Framework emphasizes issues such as process structure, process components, process interactivity and the business roles and responsibilities to which these relate. In defining these aspects, the Business Process Framework also provides a basis for setting requirements for system solutions, technical architectures, technology choices and implementation paths, but it is neutral towards the particular way that these requirements are met.

Thus, the Business Process Framework can be considered to have two faces: one oriented towards the business, customer, products, etc., and one towards solutions, systems and implementations supporting the business.

It should be recognized that through the TM Forum work, the Business Process Framework represents an industry-consensus on the Service Provider processes, which has been harmonized across the global scene and is based on Member contributions. It is allowable, and indeed expected, that this will mean that the Business Process Framework must be tailored and/or extended for use within an individual company. In particular, the Business Process Framework does not seek to constrain the way that the processes fit into a specific organization. An advantage of this positioning of the Business Process Framework as a framework, rather than a directly-implemented specification, is that differentiation amongst the Business Process Framework users is not restricted, which is vital to allow specialization and competition. In addition, as already mentioned, the Business Process Framework does not fix upon particular routes to implementation and is thus valid in many different environments with varying levels of automation, technology, etc.

So, the Business Process Framework is a framework, not a final implementation specification. It will typically be customized and extended by users for their own business needs but provides a vital common reference that is industry recognized and represents de-facto, and now through ITU-T an official standard within and between companies on business process definition.

2. Where did the Business Process Framework come from?

Work on business process modeling by the TM Forum (formerly the TeleManagement Forum and the Network Management Forum before then) began in the early 1990's with the Service Management Automation and Reengineering Team (SMART) that gathered worldwide Service Provider views and distilled an initial Business Process Model. This work grew in the Telecom Operations Map (TOM) during the mid-90's leading to the stabilization and publication of TOM in its final form towards the end of that decade.

The TOM work gained wide industry support, but the scope of the TOM model did not cover the whole of the SP enterprise and only focused on the main Operations processes embodying the traditional telecoms activities around Fulfillment, Assurance and Billing (FAB). Increasingly, the complexities of interworking in the deregulated, competitive telecoms market required a complete enterprise view, and new business demands triggered by the internet and electronic commerce generally, led to a move to expand TOM to address this wider perspective.

Thus, eTOM – for enhanced TOM – was initiated as a work program led by TM Forum as we entered the new Millennium. Initial releases of eTOM were provided to TM Forum members during 2001, and then a TM Forum Approved version of eTOM – GB921 v3.0 – was released in mid-2002. This was welcomed and adopted widely, and so further work to cement agreements, incorporate industry feedback, and extend the level of detail described resulted in further intermediate versions and then a new TM Forum Approved version early in 2004. This version – GB921 v4.0 – was also submitted under a liaison agreement to the ITU-T, which acts as the premier world-wide body with a remit under the United Nations for setting international Recommendations in the telecommunications sphere. This eTOM version was adopted by ITU-T *in toto* and has been published in parallel as their formal Recommendation M.3050, with exact alignment on the content with TM Forum's GB921 v4.0.

In 2009 due to the converging of the Information, Communications and Digital Media industries into what is now considered the Digital Services industry and the widening use of the eTOM, the TM Forum decided to rebrand the eTOM to the Business Process Framework. It was felt this would remove any artificial concerns about using the eTOM in non-telecommunications environments and broaden the uptake and adoption of the Business Process Framework (eTOM).

Throughout this history, the Business Process Framework work has benefited from wide involvement from the global telecommunications industry, as well as academia, government agencies, etc. As it has evolved, the core has shown it can stand the test of time, and it is now regarded as the pre-eminent vehicle for expressing and discussing business processes in and around the Service Provider domain. The work continues, with an increasing emphasis now that the Business Process Framework has established a clear and agreed view of the business process framework itself, on applications of the Business Process Framework and guidance to prospective and existing users on how to gain maximum benefit from the Business Process Framework in their own businesses.

3. How does the Business Process Framework work?

3.1 Domain definition

Since an earlier release of the Business Process Framework (Rel. 14.5), the collaboration team decided to formalize and generalize the notion of domains, in place of the previously existing level 0 horizontal process groupings. This allowed us to ensure consistency and sound alignment with the other components of the Framework brand (namely SID and TAM). The 7 domains that were recognized (see figure below) were:

1. Market & Sales domain
2. Customer domain
3. Product domain
4. Service Domain
5. Resource Domain
6. Business Partner domain
7. Enterprise domain

3.2 Process Decompositions

Process decomposition is a structured approach to analysis of a business through consideration of the enterprise's business processes and their internal structure. The basis of the concept is illustrated in Figure 1-1 below. Here we see a representative process element, Process X, which might provide a specific area of capability within an enterprise – say, handling of customer orders, for example. When analyzed, it is decided that the contained functionality, behavior, etc. associated with that process can/should be sub-divided into three lower-level process elements. Note that typically such a “decomposition” is partly evident from the analysis of the detail captured within the process concerned, and partly is the result of design decisions, where judgment is used to make the most appropriate partitioning for the situation under consideration.

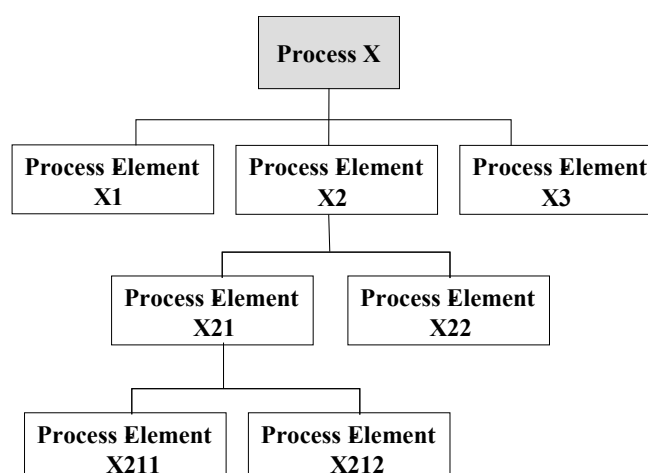


Figure 1-1: Process Decomposition

Each of the decomposed processes, X1, X2 and X3 can be further decomposed – X2 is shown as decomposed into X21 and X22 – and this can be continued – X21 is shown as decomposed into X211 and X212. Note that not all “branches” of the decomposition “tree” necessarily led to “leaves” (i.e., final process elements) at the same level of decomposition. This will depend on the scope and content of the processes involved.

The process decomposition approach has these general characteristics:

- It defines components of a process that perform part of that process
- It provides insight into the structure and content of process areas (or groupings)
- It reveals finer detail at lower levels, as decomposition proceeds
- It can be continued to as many sub-levels as are needed
- The aim is to provide a complete analysis of the process under decomposition - i.e., the sum of the components equals the totality of the original process
- It represents a static perspective of process
- It does not mandate any flow relationship between the process elements

Note that the process elements derived through process decomposition may be applied in various ways within process flows. There may be many process flows (representing, say, enterprise-specific applications) that can be built using the common set of process elements specified within the Business Process Framework. There is further discussion on process flows later in this section, including the process flow diagrams that arise and are used in this work.

The process decomposition for the Business Process Framework (see Figure 1-2) begins at the Enterprise level and defines business processes in a series of groupings. The Business Process Framework uses hierarchical decomposition to structure the business processes according to which all of the processes of the enterprise are successively decomposed. Process descriptions, inputs and outputs, as well as other key elements are defined. The Business Process Framework represents the whole of a service provider’s enterprise environment. The Framework is defined as generically as possible so that it is organization, technology, and service independent. At the overall conceptual level, the Business Process Framework can be viewed as having the following two major process areas:

Strategy to Readiness covering planning, capability delivery and lifecycle management

Operations covering the core of operational management

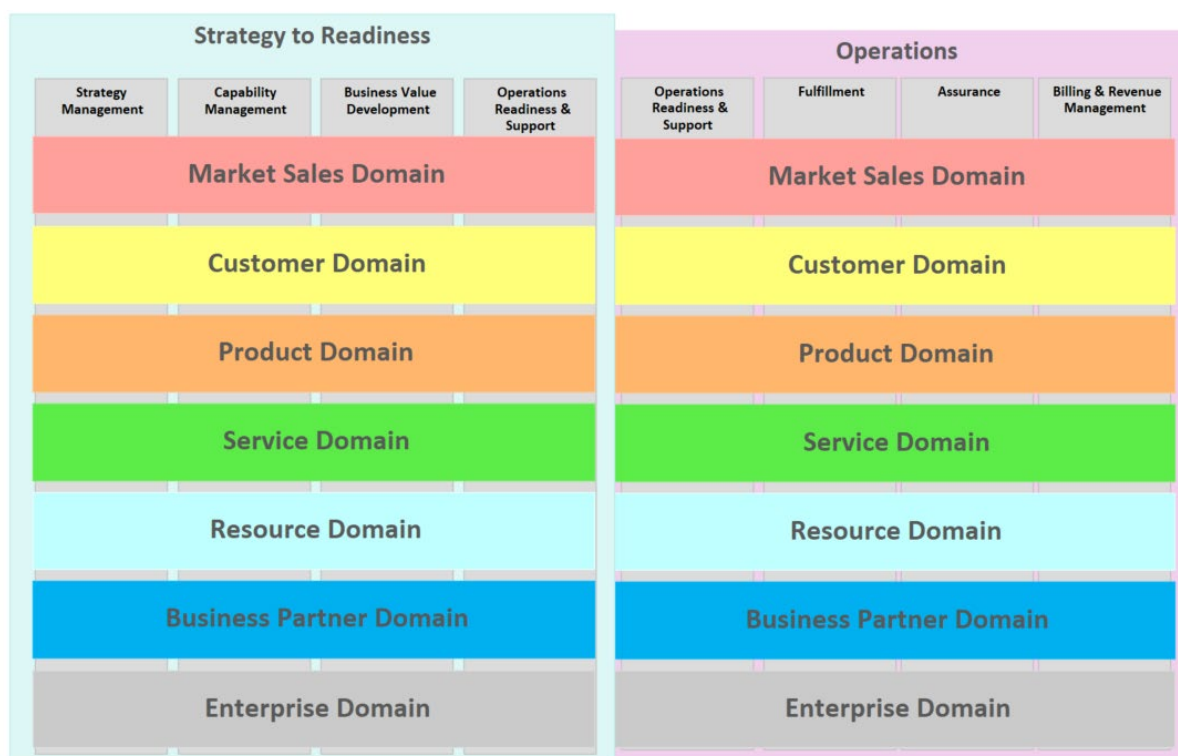


Figure 1-2: Business Process Framework (eTOM)

The Business Process Framework (see Figure 1-2) shows seven context verticals. These verticals were originally created to represent the various stages that participate in the life cycle of the enterprise from Strategy to Operations; they help classify and qualify processes when decomposing and structuring the Business Process Framework. They are part of the business process map as they represent a set of contextual boundaries for level 2 core processes. Amongst these context verticals (or vertical process groupings as they were previously known), the right side of the Framework represents the Operations process area, which is a collection of operations-centric processes covering Fulfillment, Assurance and Billing & Revenue Management (aka FAB).

Operations Readiness & Support (OR&S) is differentiated from FAB processes to highlight the focus on enabling support and automation in FAB, i.e., on-line and immediate support of customers, with OR&S ensuring that the operational environment is in place to ensure the FAB processes are able to operate optimally. Outside of the Operations process area - in the Strategy to Readiness (S2R) process area - the Strategy Management vertical, as well as the Capability Delivery and Lifecycle Management verticals, are differentiated. These are distinct because, unlike Operations, they do not directly support the customer, and are intrinsically different from the Operations processes. With the evolution of the business the sense of time has been compressed with increasing automation, and what used to be short term processes are becoming increasingly closer to real time.

The Framework also depicts cross-functional domains as they span horizontally across an enterprise's internal organization. The horizontal cross-functional process groupings (referred to as domains) in Figure 1-2 distinguish strategy-centric, development-centric processes from operations-centric processes, e.g., Marketing versus Selling, Customer Strategy versus Customer Support, Service Development versus Service Configuration, etc. Amongst these horizontal domains, those on the left (that cross the Strategy Management, Capability Delivery and Lifecycle Management verticals provide the strategy, implement the infrastructure, and define the work in the Operations process area.

The Business Process Framework Model graphically illustrates the business processes required for operating service provider enterprises. It lays out these processes first from a high-level perspective, and then drills down to increasingly detailed levels of understanding. The Business Process Framework describes in text what the model describes graphically.

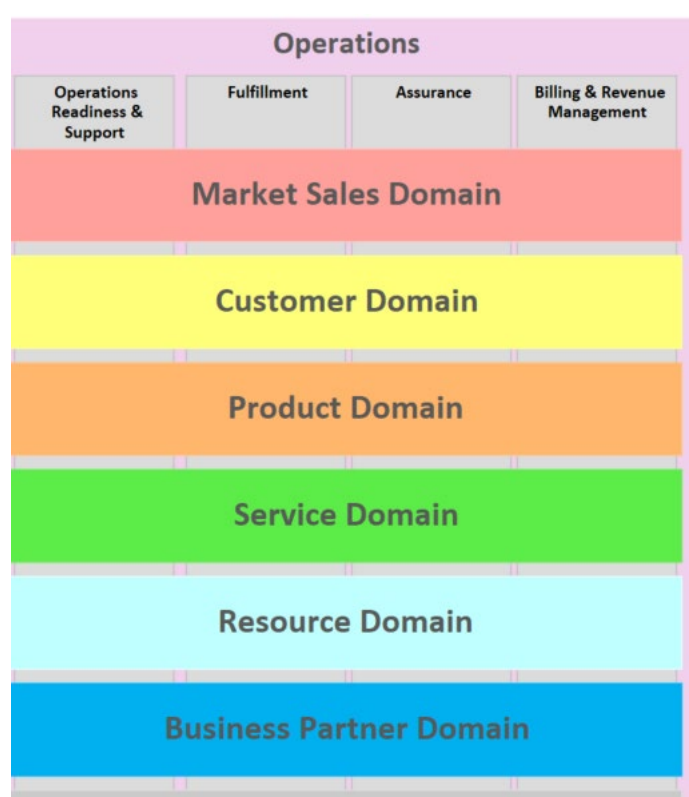


Figure 1-3 : The Business Process Framework Operations (OPS) Processes

The Business Process Framework is structured in two main process areas: Operations (OPS) and Strategy to Readiness (S2R). Each process area consists of more detailed process components and decomposition at levels 1, 2, 3, etc. This hierarchical decomposition enables detail to be defined in a structured way and also allows the Business Process Framework to be adopted at varying levels and/or for different processes. Each process element has a process ID which indicates the process level and degree of detail revealed at that level - the more digits in the process ID, the more granular detail in the process is available.

Operations (OPS - see Figure 1-3) is the heart of the Business Process Framework and much of the original TOM work has carried through into OPS (the GB921 documentation provides some insight into the relationship between the TOM and the eTOM). The “FAB” processes (Fulfillment, Assurance, Billing & Revenue Management) provide the core of the Operations area, the horizontal domains (Level 1) namely Market & Sales, Customer, Product, Service, Resource, Business Partner and Enterprise) provide the context for the definition of activity flows.

OR&S (Operations Readiness & Support) has been separated from FAB originally to reflect the separation between “front-office”, “Customer-supporting” real-time operations (in FAB) from “back-office” near real-time support processes. This split may not apply in some organizations (in which case, the OR&S and FAB processes may be merged) but it is necessary to keep the separation to distinguish their purpose and lifecycle footprint.

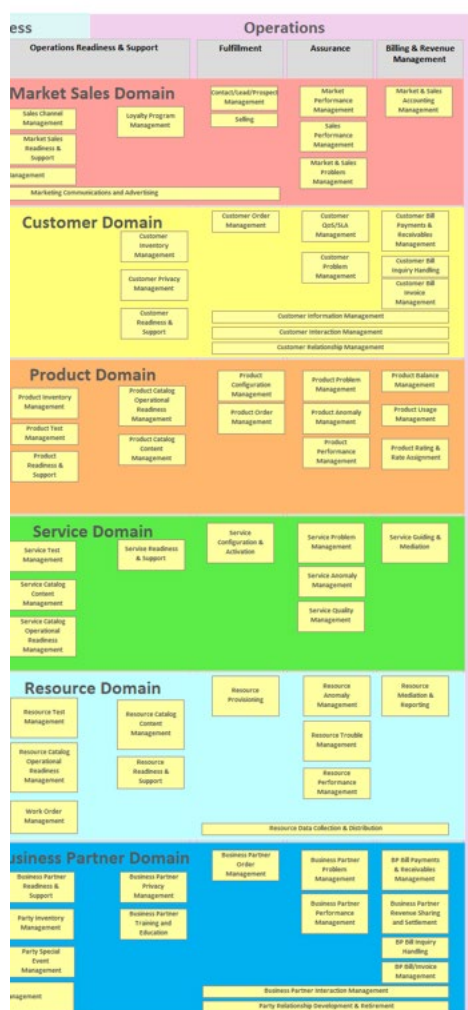


Figure 1-4 : Level 2 Operations (OPS) Processes

In Figure 1-4, the OPS area is shown with Level 2 (core) processes visible. Note that a Level 2 process is part of a horizontal domain and typically positioned within one vertical, however, in some cases, a Level 2 process can span across several context verticals (e.g., Resource Data Collection and Distribution). This is because such process belongs to more than one vertical context (e.g., for Resource Data Collection & Distribution), the data collected from the network elements may represent usage data for Billing & Revenue Management but may also support fault handling or performance assessment in Assurance).

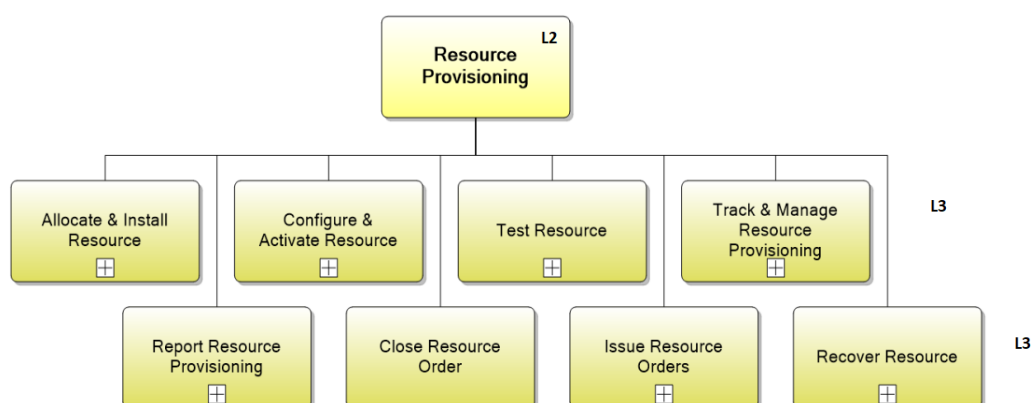


Figure 1-5 : An example of Level 3 Operations (OPS) Processes

This mechanism of decomposition can be extended as required. Figure 1-5 depicts an example of Level 3 process elements within a Level 2 process element – Resource Provisioning. Full descriptions of decompositions to Level 3 for this and other processes are included in the GB921 documentation.

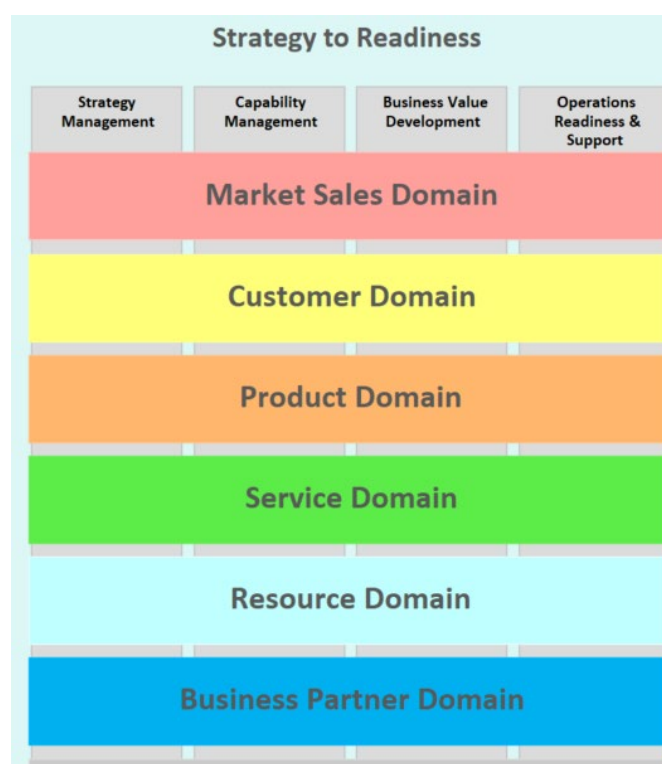


Figure 1-6: The Business Process Framework Strategy to Readiness (S2R) Processes

Strategy to Readiness (S2R – see Figure 1-6) has a similar structure to OPS with corresponding vertical and horizontal process groupings. In the verticals, Strategy Management covers the processes involved in developing the enterprise strategy and gaining commitment from the sponsoring organization for this purpose. Capability Delivery covers design and implementation of all foundational capabilities, including technology and infrastructure needed –network and IT infrastructure is probably the most obvious, but also human resources are part of the scope.

Lifecycle Management covers the lifecycle of products, services, resources and business partners– note that the Business Process Framework distinguishes Product (as exposed and sold to Customers) from Service (used internally to represent the “technical” part of the product, i.e., excluding commercial aspects such as tariffing, T&Cs, support, etc.) and Resource (physical and non-physical components used to support the service).



Figure 1-7: Level 2 Strategy to Readiness (S2R) Processes

In Figure 1-7, the S2R area is shown with Level 2 processes visible. As with OPS, domains are positioned on a vertical process grouping.

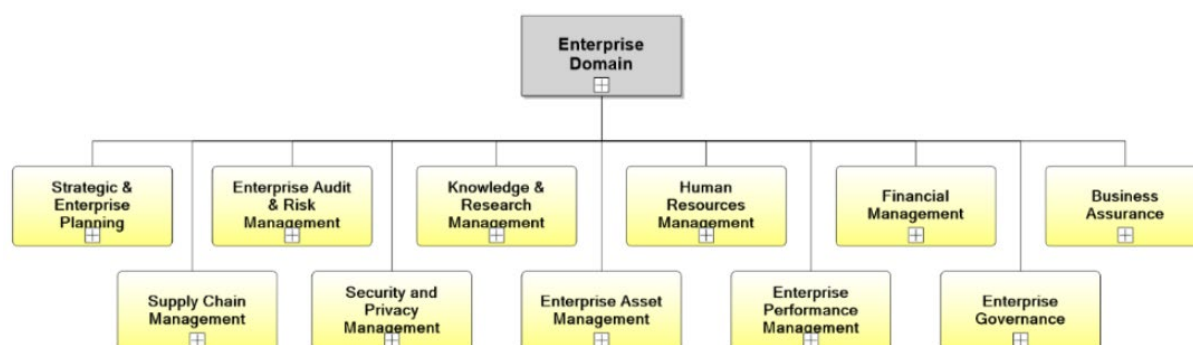


Figure 1-8: The Business Process Framework Enterprise Domain Processes

The Enterprise Domain (see Figure 1-8) shown above as a hierarchical diagram is typically represented in this view in most process modeling tools supporting the Business Process Framework. The top box is the Enterprise Domain itself (Level 1), the horizontal rows below show Level 2 processes elements.

3.3 Process Flows

Process decompositions provide an essential insight into the process definition and content. To understand further how processes behave, process flows can be developed that examine how some or all of the processes support some larger, “end-to-end” or “through” process view across the enterprise. Such process flows are not constrained to bridge across the entire enterprise – they can have any scope that is considered meaningful and helpful to analyze - but such process flows may also involve a broader area of the enterprise as depicted in specific Business Process Framework documentation (e.g., GB921E). Process flows describe specific scenarios to achieve a specific business purpose.

Figure 1-9 shows a portion of a simple process flow, where several Business Process Framework Level 2 OPS processes can be recognized, the linkages between these indicate the nature of the activity. Note that here, as well as in other diagrams in this section, the flows are examples from previous work from an older version of the Process Framework, but the approach and design principles, rather than the specificity of the flows illustrated is what the focus is on.

In the following example, a portion of the handling of a customer order is shown.

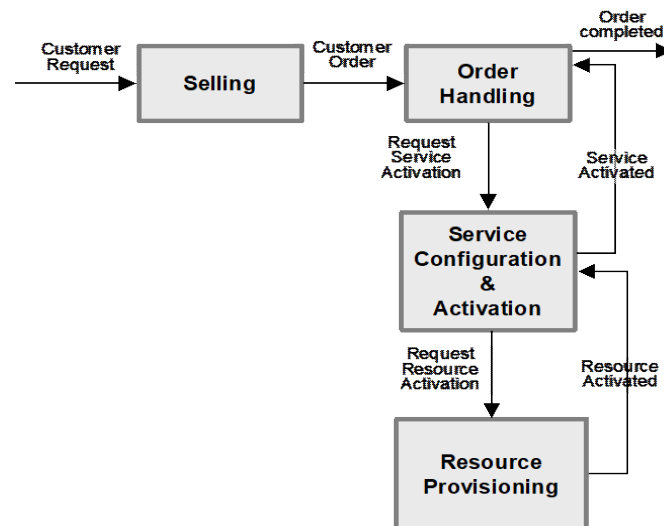


Figure 1-9: Process Flow (partial example only)

The process flow design has these general characteristics:

- It analyzes a typical (specific) scenario
- It provides insight into the behavior and interaction amongst processes
- It chooses to model the flow at an appropriate level of process detail
- It can use process decompositions to enhance/refine detail
- The aim is to provide only an example of the process flows - i.e., only some of the possible interactions are described in each scenario
- Thus, it typically provides a partial view of process behavior (because flows are based on specific scenarios)
- It represents a dynamic perspective of processes.

In applying this approach for Business Process Framework process flows, it has been found that several different flow-related diagram types have proved useful, considering the variety of interests (business and technical, high level and detailed design) that needs to be addressed.

This is initially a general positioning type of diagram that provides limited insight into the flow but helps focus on the contextual part of the Business Process Framework involved.

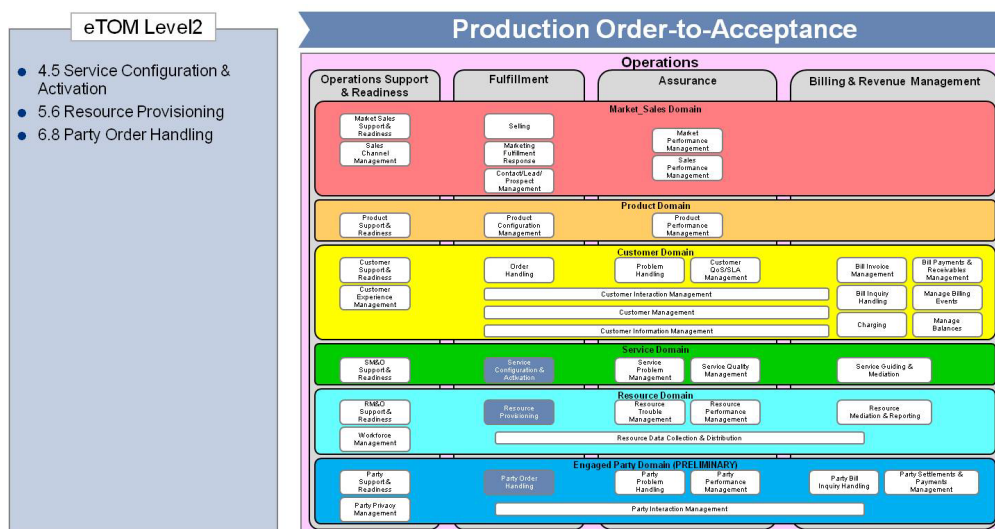


Figure 1-10: General Interaction Diagram for Production Order to Acceptance

Figure 1-10 shows an example of this diagram - a general process interaction diagram – for a scenario based around Production Order to Acceptance in the Fulfillment vertical that is covered in the GB921E documentation. This shows some of the process interactions that arise for this scenario but does not give any detailed insight at this level into the behavior. It is still useful for a high-level view, though.

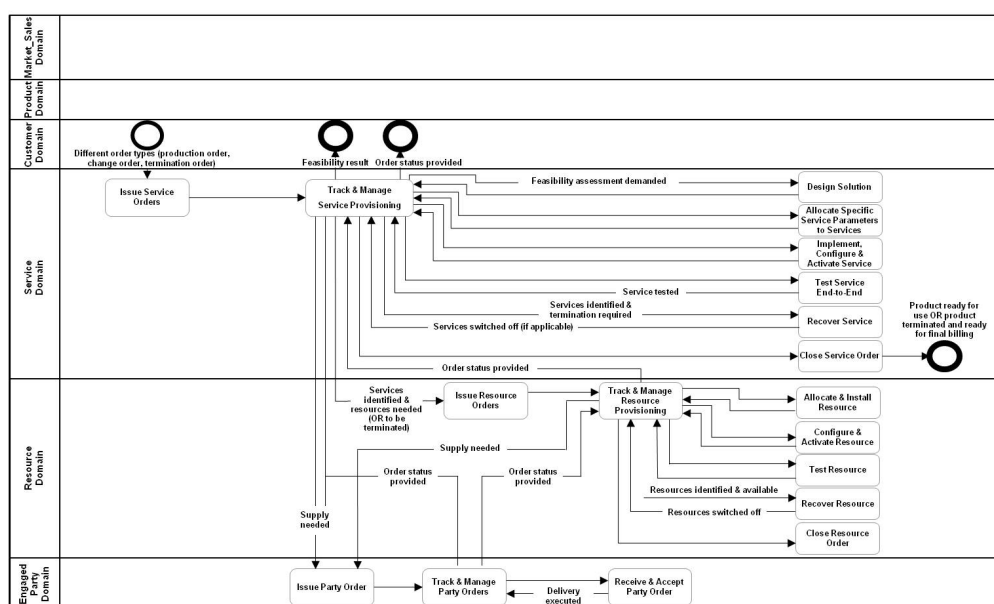


Figure 1-11: Process Interaction Flow Diagram for Production Order to Acceptance

The next diagram type, shown in Figure 1-11, is developed directly from a process analysis and modeling tool (rather than a general drawing software). Here the scope is with Level 2 process elements, but other Levels can be used depending on the detail required. This diagram type positions the processes in relatively the same way as in their representation on the Business Process Framework model diagrams, which helps avoid confusion. Each process only appears once, and so sequencing of the interactions is not explicit in this diagram (shown on process dynamics diagrams later).

“Swim lanes” are an important element in this type of workflow diagram. These are functional lanes of partitions of the process flow, which depict typically where the responsibility lies in those process elements with respect to the overall process flow (each swim-lane represents a line of responsibility for the tasks involved in such lane). In this example, the swim lanes have been drawn to represent the four horizontal functional process groupings of the Operations area of the Process Framework, since the scenario involved is focused on the Operations domain. In this arrangement, all the process elements in a specific swim lane in the diagram are components of that horizontal functional process grouping. It should be noted that swim lanes (despite their name) need not be only horizontal, although this is a common choice for clarity, and is the approach used in the Business Process Framework process flow diagrams.

The process flow in Figure 1-11 addresses the Production Order to Acceptance stage of Fulfillment (other phases are documented in separate diagrams, for convenience). It begins with the Service Configuration & Activation process. Note that interactions between processes are events and are not intrinsically information transfers. Thus, they can be considered to represent transfer of control.

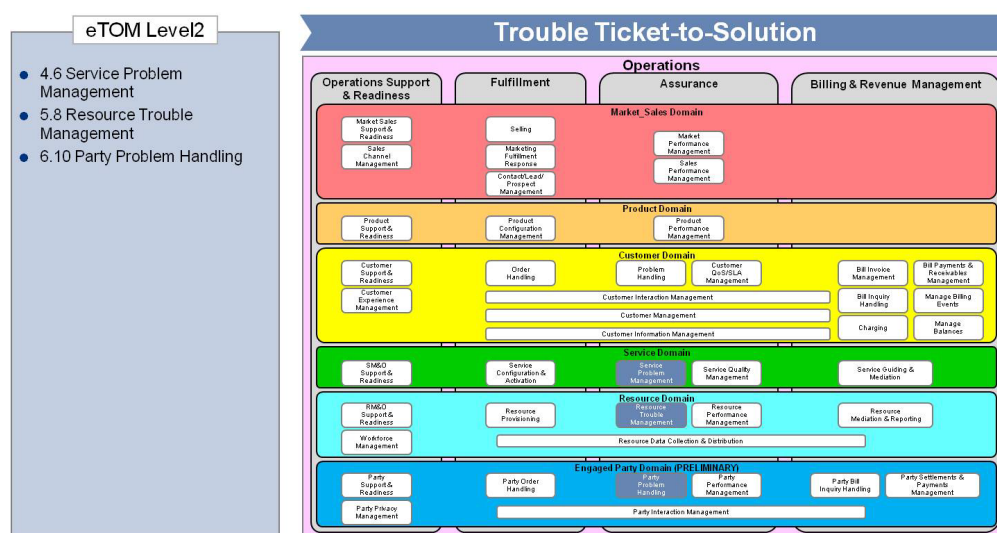


Figure 1-12: Process Interaction Flow Diagram for Trouble Ticket-to-Solution (Assurance)

Figure 1-12 is another example of this diagram type, for the Trouble Ticketing process part of Assurance. It begins with the generation of a trouble ticket request or event, and then tracks the execution flow through Service Problem Management, Resource Trouble Management and the Business Partner domain which may actually be involved in the delivery of the service to the customer.

However, even though interactions are labeled in these diagrams, sequencing and dependencies in the flow are still not explicit. For this, a different kind of diagram is needed.

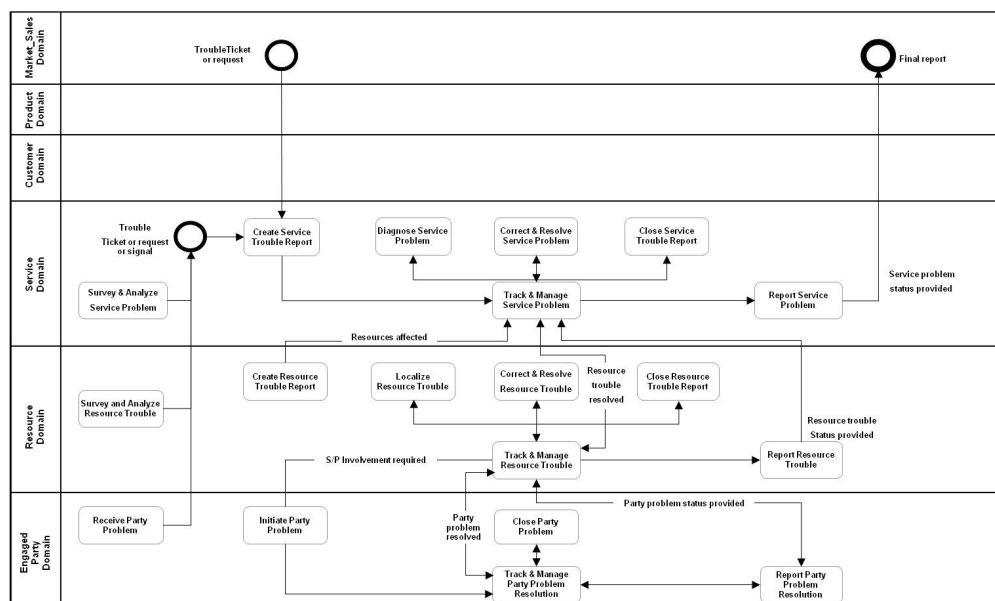


Figure 1-13: Process Dynamics Flow Diagram for Trouble Ticket-to-Solution (Assurance)

Figure 1-13 represents a process flow diagram, showing explicitly the dynamics of the process. Each process typically appears several times, each time providing a specific step in the process flow sequence. As different functionality comes into play on each appearance, this diagram can provide insight into the decomposition of the Level 2 process into more granular processes. It shows similar information as the Trouble Ticketing process interaction diagram of Figure 1-12, but it is more elaborate and provides a broader basis for further design.

Developing process flows in this way is a valuable source of insight and additional detail to validate process decompositions, and to address specific areas of business priority for the use of the Business Process Framework.

The adoption of the Process Framework in no way precludes the adoption of specific best practice workflows such as those available in ITIL® which provides workflow designs according to global IT Service Management standards along with suggested best practices. The value of the Business Process Framework is therefore in delivering reusable, well defined, process components.

4. Why use the Business Process Framework?

- The Framework provides a standard structure, terminology and classification scheme for describing business processes and their constituent building blocks.
- The Framework supplies a foundation for applying enterprise-wide discipline to the development of business processes.
- The Framework provides a basis for understanding and managing portfolios of IT applications in terms of business process requirements.
- The Framework enables creation of consistent and high-quality end-to-end process flows, with opportunities for cost and performance improvement, and for re-use of existing processes and systems.
- The deployment and adoption of the Framework across the industry increases the likelihood that standard, interoperable, application components will be integration-ready at a lower cost than traditional off-the-shelf or custom-built applications.

5. When can the Business Process Framework help?

The Business Process Framework can be adopted and used as a tool for analyzing your organization's existing processes and for developing new processes. Different processes delivering the same business functionality can be identified, duplication eliminated, gaps revealed, new process design expedited, and variance reduced. The Business Process Framework can prove helpful in assessing the value, cost and performance of individual processes within your organization.

The Business Process Framework can facilitate communication and interactions with suppliers and business partners by identifying and categorizing the processes that are relevant for such interactions. In a similar manner, the Business Process Framework can facilitate the identification of important customer relationship processes and evaluate whether they are functioning as required to meet customer expectations.

6. Who is using the Business Process Framework?

A natural question that arises is where and how the Business Process Framework is being used across the industry and how it is benefiting organizations involved. It is difficult to collect very detailed information about the use and benefits derived from its adoption across the industry, this is due to confidentiality concerns and sensitivity on strategic approach and direction; however, several major organizations have disclosed their position on this matter publicly, and the general interest and adoption of the Business Process Framework has been quite significant over the years and the perception is that the trend is still growing.

The two main groups of Business Process Framework users are (1) Service Providers and (2) Vendors, System Integrators, etc. It is worth noting that it is estimated that there is a much larger number of organizations applying the Process Framework in their businesses, and also a large number of organizations using the Process Framework, who are either not actively involved with the TM Forum, or even unknown to the Forum.

A vital source of insight on users and projects linked with the TM Forum work and related assets is the growing number of available case studies outlining how individual companies have applied the framework. Many of these relate to the Business Process Framework (often using the “eTOM” acronym); some of the case studies can be viewed through the following link:

<http://www.tmforum.org/CaseStudies>

Another important source is the presentations made at conference events such as Digital Transformation World (see <http://www.tmforum.org/Conferences>)

Another aspect of Business Process Framework adoption is through other industry bodies that are operating in, or have influence on, the area. For example, the Business Process Framework has been endorsed by ITU-T. This represents a major achievement and establishes the Business Process Framework (eTOM), which has grown already to become a *de facto* standard, as a formal standard Recommendation (identified as M.3050) through ITU-T with its mandate under the United Nations.

7. Some Ideas on Using the Business Process Framework

Service Providers

1. Assign your technical personnel to review the Business Process Framework and Model, and to present recommendations on adopting it for your enterprise (see www.tmforum.org for download advice).
2. Encourage your vendors to understand the Business Process Framework, and. to describe their software applications in relation to the Business Process Framework.
3. If you want your company's view incorporated in future versions of the Business Process Framework, send a representative to participate actively in its ongoing development.

Vendors

1. Provide references on your software products for customers using the Business Process Framework structure and concepts.
2. Assist your customers' understanding of your software products by explaining your software products in relation to the Business Process Framework.
3. Use the Business Process Framework as a guide to help generate product gap analysis, market analysis, competitive analysis, etc.
4. Establish and build partnerships to produce more complete solutions for service providers.
5. Leverage the Business process framework to deliver reusable, and thus more affordable, solutions and products based on other best practices such as ITIL®, TOGAF®, COBIT® and others.
6. To ensure the Business Process Framework accurately reflects how the telecom business operates, send a representative to participate in its ongoing development.

Note: Vendors, System Integrators and related companies are generally comprised of common roles. The common roles are shown below with a brief description of each role. These common roles are not prescriptive. Rather, they are provided to illustrate the breadth of the Business Process Framework impact on vendor and system integrator organizational roles.

- Senior Management:
 - Mission & strategy
- Business:
 - Customer, market needs & issues
 - Portfolio generation & management
 - Value proposition
 - Business case development
 - Partnerships
- Marketing:
 - Market & competitive analysis
 - Branding, advertising, promotions, etc.
 - Public relations

- Sales:
 - RFQs, RFIs, RFPs, contracts, etc.
- Finance:
 - Revenue & cost forecasting
 - Order to cash, billing, etc.
- Systems Engineering:
 - Research and Design
 - System design: architecture, interfaces, etc.
 - Technology, etc. roadmaps
- Development Engineering:
 - Hardware, software, services products and solutions
- Test:
 - System, product, field, compliance, “X-ility” (Availability, Operability, ...), etc. testing & certification
- Manufacturing:
 - Supply chain (in)
 - Warranty, etc.
- Deployment:
 - Supply chain (out)
 - Delivery & installation
 - Acceptance test
 - Field trials, Field problem resolution, MOL

Bringing the Business Process Framework into your Business – Some hints and Suggestions

To evaluate and use the Business Process Framework for your own business, it is essential that the ground is prepared so that the goals are clear, and it is possible to assess the impact of this.

As a first step, it is important to gain internal commitment and sponsor support for the adoption of the Business Process Framework, since the kind of business process analysis, and possible changes that will result, need buy-in and active participation from those involved. A critical success factor is obtaining senior management recognition and support.

It is also critical to identify and assess the area(s) where the Process Framework may bring benefit, and to define success criteria for any trial or pilot use, so that results can be leveraged to build confidence and justify further work.

In using the Business Process Framework, it is important to recognize that it provides a ready-made generic business process framework, which may need adapting for your business, and that it is progressively being further developed to lower-level detail.

The Business Process Framework can be used directly:

- to assist your business partitioning (Process groupings and definitions to define roles and responsibilities within your organization)
- to procure solutions from vendors that identify which processes within the Process Framework are being supported

- to bring economies of scale
- to reduce product development cycles
- To facilitate process customization and extension

Furthermore, the Process Framework can be adapted and extended to accommodate specific needs in your own area:

- use the Process Framework as a baseline
- define additional detail and extensions in areas specific to your business
- influence ongoing Business Process Framework development work through direct participation
 - share ideas and gain insight
 - ensure the Process Framework evolves in line with your needs
 - maximize the relevance of industry products

In extending and customizing the Business Process Framework, a number of strategies can be considered:

Bottom-up

- Start with your enterprise existing Business Processes definitions
- Map existing Business Process flows back to the Business Process Framework
- Construct your own decomposition of the Business Process Framework published Business Processes

Top down

- Decompose the Business Process Framework processes into more granular processes, to expose more detail
- Define process flows, to link processes together
- Combine decompositions and flows, to describe fully the behavior of each process area
- Continue (as required) to lower levels of detail

The approach used can be adjusted as convenient in each case. Experience shows there is value in firming up agreement at a given level of decomposition and analysis, before proceeding to develop fully the next level of detail (of course, it may be helpful to “look ahead” a little to ensure that the current level of detail is resilient).

8. Administrative Appendix

8.1 Acknowledgements

This release of the Business Process Framework is the result of the combined efforts of a large group of individuals from companies all over the world. Most noteworthy is the participation of numerous service providers. The knowledge and commitment in providing contributions and participating in discussions are greatly appreciated. Contributors over the program leading to previous Business Process Framework/eTOM releases were acknowledged in those documents.

The team looks forward to continued input and involvement for ongoing work on the Business Process Framework. Thank you for making this the acknowledged, best framework for the Communications and Digital Services industry.

See main document (GB921 Concepts and Principles) for other acknowledgements.

8.2 Document History

8.2.1 Version History

Version Number	Date Modified	Modified by:	Description of changes
eTOM Addendum P NGOSS Version 4.5	05/04		Launch of this Addendum, packaged as GB921P for this release. Provides an introduction to eTOM and can be used as a primer for the rest of the GB921 documents
Version 4.6	11/04		Minor updates prior to Member Evaluation.
Version 4.7	06/09		Minor updates to reflect TM Forum Approved status
Version 4.8	Jan 2010	Mike Kelly (with some updates by Ken Dilbeck)	Small terminology changes to use "Business Process Framework" and to update diagrams; incorporation of member review comments
Version 4.9	March 2010	Alicja Kawecki	Minor cosmetic corrections for web posting
Version 4.10	April 2011	Alicja Kawecki	Updated to reflect TM Forum Approved status
Version 5.0	May 2014	Viviane Cohen, Hugo Vaughan	Assimilation of the vertical processes as simple groupings, minor edits to reflect changing industry terms and co-solutions.
Version 5.0.1	May 2014	Alicja Kawecki	Applied rebranding, updated cover, header, footer & Notice; minor cosmetic edits prior to posting
Version 5.0.2	June 2014	Alicja Kawecki	Correction to cover page
Version 5.0.3	Sep 2014	Avi Talmor	Correction on p. 12 per Member Evaluation feedback
5.0.4	Oct 2014	Alicja Kawecki	Updated cover and Notice to reflect TM Forum Approved status

Version Number	Date Modified	Modified by:	Description of changes
15.0.0	May 2015	Viviane Cohen	Amendments based on changes to Framework
15.0.1	May 2015	Alicja Kawecki	Updated cover, header, Notice
15.0.2	16 December 2015	Alicja Kawecki	Updated cover, header and Notice to reflect TM Forum Approved status
15.0.3	06-Jul-2018	Adrienne Walcott	Formatting/style edits prior to R18 publishing
15.0.4	24-Sep-2018	Adrienne Walcott	Updated to reflect TM Forum Approved Status
19.0.0	11-Aug-2019	Alfred Anaya-Dubernard	Updates to align with Fx19 and GB991
19.0.1	17-Oct-2019	Adrienne Walcott	Updated to reflect TM Forum Approved Status
21.0.0	28-May-2021	Avi Talmor	Updated diagrams
21.0.1	12-Jul-2021	Avi Talmor	Updated to reflect comments received during publishing review cycle
22.5.1	09-Mar-2022	Alfred Anaya	Updated to ensure more clarity, consistency and alignment with ODA and release 21.5

8.2.2 Release History

Release Status	Date Modified	Modified by:	Description of changes
8.1	Jan 2010	Mike Kelly (with some updates by Ken Dilbeck)	Small terminology changes to use “Business Process Framework” and to update diagrams; incorporation of member review comments
14.0	May 2014	Hugo Vaughan	Assimilation of the vertical processes as simple groupings, minor edits to reflect changing industry terms and co-solutions
15.0	May 2015	Viviane Cohen	Amendments based on changes to Framework
18.0	June 2018	Alfred Anaya-Dubernard	Updates to align with Fx18 and GB991
18.0.1	24-Sep-2018	Adrienne Walcott	Updated to reflect TM Forum Approved Status
19.0	22-July-2019	Alfred Anaya-Dubernard	Updates to align with Fx19 and GB991
19.0.1	17-Oct-2019	Adrienne Walcott	Updated to reflect TM Forum Approved Status
Pre-production	28-May-2021	Avi Talmor	Updated diagrams
Production	22-Jul-2022	Adrienne Walcott	Updated to reflect TM Forum Approved Status
Pre-production	09-Dec-2022	Avi Talmor	Updated to Release 22.5
Production	13-Feb-2023	Adrienne Walcott	Updated to reflect TM Forum Approved Status